KEN DALA

THE KEN DALA COLLECTION / 2026

KAZAKHSTAN

BEYOND THE ORDINARY

A considered guide to the places, flavours and practical details that make a journey unforgettable.

THE COMPLETE TRAVELLER'S COMPANION

A premium companion for international travellers

START HERE

Your journey, curated.

Everything worth knowing before you go — designed to be saved, shared and taken along.

01 **The essentials**
Currency, language, time and entry

02 **When to visit**
Seasons, weather and what to pack

03 **Places to remember**
From Istanbul to the turquoise coast

04 **Move beautifully**
Airports, city transport and intercity travel

05 **Live like a local**
Culture, dining, payments and useful apps

06 **Travel confidently**
Safety, checklists and essential links

01 / THE ESSENTIALS

Know before you go

A few practical details will make your arrival in Kazakhstan smoother.

Currency

Kazakhstani tenge (KZT / ₸). Cards and QR payments are common in cities; keep cash for rural stops.

Language

Kazakh is the state language; Russian is also widely used. English is less common outside major tourist venues.

Time zone

Kazakhstan uses UTC+5 nationwide, year-round. Check the time difference with your home country.

Electricity

220V, 50Hz. Type C and F plugs are standard; bring an adapter if needed.

PASSPORT & ENTRY

Visa rules depend on nationality and length of stay. Many passports qualify for visa-free short visits, while others require a visa. Check Kazakhstan's official eGov or diplomatic sources and confirm passport validity before departure.

02 / TIMING

Find your season.

Kazakhstan is vast: mountain weather, steppe temperatures and city climates vary considerably.

SPRING

MAR – MAY • 0–22°C

Blooming cities and foothills; variable rain and lingering mountain snow.

SUMMER

JUN – AUG • 20–35°C

Mountain hikes, lakes and long days; some southern cities get very hot.

AUTUMN

SEP – NOV • -2–23°C

Golden foliage around Almaty, clear days and cooler evenings.

WINTER

DEC – FEB • -25–5°C

Snowy landscapes, skiing and severe cold in northern and eastern regions.

Temperatures are broad illustrations, not forecasts; extremes vary by region.

03 / DESTINATIONS

Places worth the journey.

Build an itinerary around a feeling, not simply a checklist.

01

ALMATY

City beneath the peaks

Leafy streets, cafés, mountain views and access to Medeu and Shymbulak. Allow 3–5 days.

02

ASTANA

A futuristic capital

Striking architecture, museums and broad boulevards. Winters are extremely cold. Allow 2–3 days.

03

CHARYN CANYON

A landscape of scale

Dramatic rock formations east of Almaty. Plan a full day and check road conditions.

03 / DESTINATIONS

Beyond the icons.

Build an itinerary around a feeling, not simply a checklist.

04

KOLSAY & KAINDY

Alpine lake magic

Forest-lined lakes, hiking and Kaindy's famous submerged trees; permits and access may vary.

05

TURKESTAN

Silk Road heritage

The UNESCO-listed Mausoleum of Khoja Ahmed Yasawi and historic southern Kazakhstan.

06

BURABAY & MANGYSTAU

Two wild frontiers

Pine forests and lakes near Burabay; surreal desert formations in far-west Mangystau.

04 / ARRIVALS

Arrive with ease.

The main airports and practical entry points for exploring Kazakhstan.

ALA — **Almaty International**
Primary gateway to Almaty and the southeastern mountains.

NQZ — **Astana International**
Serves the capital and northern Kazakhstan.

CIT — **Shymkent International**
Gateway to southern Kazakhstan and Turkestan region.

SCO — **Aktau International**
Useful for Mangystau's desert landscapes and Caspian coast.

GUW — **Atyrau International**
Western Kazakhstan gateway, with regional connections.

UKK — **Oskemen Airport**
Access to East Kazakhstan; route availability varies.

Flight planning: International routes and seasonal schedules change. Check both Almaty and Astana for the best connections to your itinerary.

05 / MOBILITY

The art of getting around.

Distances are significant: combine flights, trains and local transport thoughtfully.



In the city

Almaty has a metro, buses and taxis; Astana has buses and taxis. Local transit payment methods differ.



Between cities

Domestic flights save time. Kazakhstan has an extensive rail network, including overnight sleeper trains; book ahead.



Airport transfers

Use official taxis, reputable ride-hailing apps or arranged transfers. Confirm pickup details before arrival.



Road trips

Remote scenic routes may require a 4x4, local guide, supplies and weather checks. Distances between fuel stops can be long.

06 / SPENDING

Money, made simple.

Pay confidently while allowing for differences between city and countryside.

Cards & cash

Cards are common in cities and larger hotels. Keep tenge cash for bazaars, rural cafés and remote areas.

ATMs & banks

Major banks include Halyk Bank, Kaspi Bank, Bank CenterCredit and ForteBank. Check your own bank's fees.

Exchange wisely

Use reputable banks or exchange counters. Review live rates and avoid costly conversion into your home currency.

Budget planning

Costs differ between Almaty, Astana and remote tours. Allow for transport, guide fees, park entry and seasonal prices.

A SMART TRAVEL HABIT

Local QR payment systems may require a domestic bank account. Carry an international card and some cash as backup.

07 / LOCAL LIFE

The culture of welcome.

Discover the generous hospitality and traditions of the steppe.

Hospitality & respect

Guests are traditionally welcomed warmly. Accept offered tea graciously; ask before photographing people or private homes.

Useful local words

Salem = hello (informal) • Raqmet = thank you • Iä / Joq = yes / no in Kazakh. Russian is widely spoken.

Food worth travelling for

Try beshbarmak, baursak, manty, plov and hearty soups. Horse-meat dishes are traditional; ask about ingredients.

Heritage & customs

Explore yurt traditions, nomadic culture and historic Silk Road sites. Dress respectfully at religious locations.

08 / TOOLKIT

Your pocket concierge.

Download the essentials and save offline details before leaving the city.

NAVIGATION

2GIS • Google Maps

2GIS is especially useful in major cities; download offline maps.

LANGUAGE

Google Translate

Save Kazakh and Russian languages for offline assistance.

TRANSPORT

Yandex Go • local transit apps

Ride-hailing availability varies; check pickup locations and fares.

AIR TRAVEL

Air Astana • FlyArystan

Check schedules, baggage rules and flight notifications.

STAYS & EXPERIENCES

Your booking provider’s app

Save hotel addresses, tour vouchers and guide contacts offline.

CONNECTIVITY

Carrier app • eSIM provider

Check roaming, SIM registration and local mobile-network requirements.

09 / ESSENTIALS

Travel with confidence.

Preparation matters when travelling across large distances and changing climates.

1

Emergency

Dial 112 for the unified emergency service in Kazakhstan.

2

Documents

Carry your passport, insurance, booking details and offline copies; check local registration requirements.

3

Mountain safety

Check weather, trail access and altitude. Use qualified guides for remote or high-altitude adventures.

4

Health

Pack prescriptions in original packaging and check medicine-import rules.

5

Connectivity

Coverage may be weak outside cities; save maps and share your remote-trip plans.

6

Road awareness

Avoid poorly planned night drives on remote roads; confirm vehicle readiness and fuel stops.

10 / DEPARTURE

The final checklist.

A beautifully simple way to leave nothing important behind.

- [ ] Passport and visa and entry requirements checked
- [ ] Flights, hotel addresses and airport transfers saved
- [ ] Travel insurance and emergency contacts stored
- [ ] Bank cards, some Kazakh lira and backup funds ready
- [ ] Offline maps, translation tools and booking apps installed
- [ ] Season-appropriate clothing and comfortable walking shoes
- [ ] Power adapter, charger and medication packed
- [ ] Weather, transport and attraction opening hours rechecked

For a smoother trip: Keep copies of important documents offline and share your itinerary with someone you trust.

11 / INSPIRATION

Make it your own.

Three ways to explore Kazakhstan, from city culture to dramatic landscapes.

5 DAYS

The Almaty escape

Almaty • Medeu • Shymbulak

A stylish city stay paired with mountain scenery and local dining.

8 DAYS

Lakes & canyons

Almaty • Charyn • Kolsay • Kaindy

A nature-focused adventure; allow for long drives and seasonal access.

10 DAYS

Cities & heritage

Astana • Almaty • Turkestan

Modern architecture, mountain views and Silk Road history in one journey.

12 / TRUSTED SOURCES

Useful links, always.

Entry rules, schedules and park access can change. Confirm before travel.

ENTRY & VISAS

egov.kz • gov.kz

TOURISM & DESTINATIONS

kazakhstan.travel

AIR TRAVEL

airastana.com • flyarystan.com

RAIL TRAVEL

bilet.railways.kz

WEATHER

kazhydromet.kz

EMERGENCIES

112 — unified emergency number

Editorial note: This guide offers general information, not a visa guarantee or live quotation. Confirm current requirements for your passport, itinerary and travel dates.

KEN DALA

THE WORLD IS YOURS TO DISCOVER.

Extraordinary journeys begin with curiosity — and the freedom to travel well.

KEN DALA / CURATED TRAVEL EXPERIENCES